

**ONE'S DESTINATION IS NEVER A PLACE
BUT A NEW WAY OF SEEING THINGS.**

HENRY MILLER, AMERICAN WRITER

Vacation money

There are almost 200 countries in the world, and most have their own currency. Only a few, such as the 19 European countries of the Eurozone, share a single currency, so it's almost inevitable that if you travel to a foreign country, people there will use different money from yours. In a very few places, stores and businesses will accept other major currencies such as US dollars or euros, but everywhere else, if you want to buy something you'll have to pay in the local currency. So, you'll have to change money into the currency of the country you are visiting. You can do this at most banks, or at a currency exchange office. But what you may not realize, is that you cannot exchange your money for the same amount in the other currency. The bank or *bureau de change* will charge you for making the transaction, and this is normally a percentage of the money you are changing.